Skyline Routine User Guide

1. What This Tool Is For

Skyline Routine is a desktop flight reminder.

Instead of showing a notification that disappears after a few seconds, it sends a plane across your screen when a reminder is due. The plane keeps cruising until you click the plane or the reminder text to acknowledge it. If you do not click, it lands automatically after the maximum flight time.

It is useful for small but important things that are easy to ignore:

- Drinking water, standing up, or taking a screen break
- Taking medicine, meetings, appointments, or leaving work on time
- Pomodoro sessions, stretching, meditation, or eye rest
- Any recurring routine that should be **seen and acknowledged**

In one sentence: **turn a schedule into a flight that takes off on time, so the reminder actually gets your attention.**

Reminder data stays on your computer. There is no account and no cloud sync.

2. Quick Start

1. Install and open Skyline Routine.
2. On first launch, choose water, standing, eye rest, medicine, or focus to create a reminder and preview a flight.
3. Then click **New reminder**.
4. Enter the reminder text, then choose a departure time and repeat mode.
5. Click **Save route**.
6. Keep the app running. When the time comes, a plane appears on screen.
7. Click the plane or the reminder text to end it. If you do nothing, it lands automatically after the maximum flight time.

Closing the settings window does not quit the app. Skyline Routine stays in the system tray and keeps triggering reminders.

3. Free and Pro

The Mac App Store edition is **free to download with a one-time Pro in-app purchase**. There is no subscription:

	Free	Pro
Active reminders	Up to 3	Unlimited

	Free	Pro
Built-in aircraft	4 basic styles	All 18 styles
Custom flight paths	Up to 1	Unlimited
Multiple time windows	Not included	Included
Reminder card styles	2	All 6
Custom aircraft image	Not included	Included, multiple images supported
Theme styles	Default Skyline	Skyline + Aurora / Sunset / Midnight / 1024 / Candy / Anime
Languages / auto-land	Included	Included

- Click **Upgrade to Pro** at the top right to see the App Store price and purchase.
- Pro unlocks immediately after purchase; use **Restore purchases** on another Mac.
- Selecting a locked aircraft, a Pro theme, or a custom image also opens the upgrade panel.
- Pro is a one-time purchase, not a subscription. Apple handles payment; reminder data stays on your computer.

4. Installation

macOS

Requires macOS 13 or later.

1. Open the downloaded DMG.
2. **Applications** is on the left and **Skyline Routine** is on the right; drag the app into **Applications**.
3. Launch it from **Applications**.

If macOS says you are running a disk-image copy, quit the app completely and open the copy in **Applications**. Running directly from the DMG also disables features such as launch at login.

The app is not currently notarized by Apple. If macOS blocks the first launch, allow it in **System Settings → Privacy & Security**.

Windows

- **Installer**: run `Skyline Routine Setup x.x.x.exe` and follow the prompts.
- **Portable**: run `Skyline Routine x.x.x.exe` directly; no installation is required.

5. Creating a Reminder

From the main window, click **New reminder** and fill in the following:

Reminder text

Up to 100 characters, for example "Drink water", "Stand up for two minutes", or "Meeting prep". Long text wraps automatically and is shown in full on the flight overlay.

Departure time and repeat mode

Repeat mode	Behavior	What to set
Daily	Remind at the same time every day	Departure time
Weekdays	Remind Monday through Friday	Departure time
Once	Remind only once on a chosen date	Date + departure time
Interval	Repeat within a time range	Repeat days, interval, start/end time

For **Once**, the date and time must be in the future. After it fires, the switch turns off automatically. If you edit it to a future date and time and save, it turns back on automatically.

For **Interval**, also set:

- **Repeat on**: daily, weekdays, or once.
- **Remind every**: for example, every 30 minutes or every 2 hours.
- **Start time / End time**: only remind inside this window, for example 09:00–18:00.
- **Second time window**: Pro can add another window, for example 09:00–12:00 and 14:00–18:00.

The interval cannot be longer than the time window. For example, a 09:00–18:00 window allows an interval of up to 9 hours. The editor shows the current maximum.

Aircraft

Each reminder can use its own aircraft:

- Built-in aircraft: Fighter, Stealth fighter, Airliner, Transport, Bomber, Reconnaissance, Propeller, Biplane, Airship, Flying carriage, Glider, Seaplane, Helicopter, Paper plane, UFO, Rocket, Drone, Hot air balloon.
- Custom image: PNG, JPG, or WebP; transparent PNG backgrounds look best. Pro can select multiple images at once or add more in **Settings → Default aircraft**; each image can be selected or deleted separately.
- **Use default**: use the default aircraft from Settings.

Flight height

Choose **Use default**, **High**, **Mid**, or **Low**. This affects only the current reminder.

Custom flight paths

Open **Settings → Flight paths** to create one or more routes:

1. Click **New path**.
2. Enter a name.

3. Press and drag on the canvas, which uses the current screen aspect ratio, to draw the route.
4. Click **Save path**.

When creating or editing a reminder, choose under **Flight path**:

- **Follow flight height**: uses the High / Mid / Low setting above.
- **A saved custom path**: the plane follows that route and ignores flight height.

The free version saves one path; Pro saves unlimited paths. Routes are smoothed automatically; an open route enters from outside the screen, leaves along the end direction, waits until both the plane and text card are fully off-screen, turns around outside, and flies back from the endpoint side. The same turn happens at the start side. The text card stays behind the plane and at a readable angle.

Reminder card style

Choose **Follow settings**, or pick a style just for this reminder:

- Skyline glass: free, translucent dark glass card that shows the desktop behind it; the default style.
- Deep solid: free, fully opaque dark card with stronger contrast.
- Flight outline: Pro, transparent background with a glowing outline.
- Boarding pass: Pro, light paper card with dark text.
- Neon night: Pro, dark card with cyan and pink neon light.
- Minimal text: Pro, no card background, just the text.

With **Follow settings**, the reminder uses the default from **Settings → Appearance & language → Reminder card style**; later changes to that default apply automatically.

Save

Click **Save route**. New reminders appear at the top of the route list.

To choose the repeat mode used by future reminders, open **Settings → New reminder default**. That setting only affects new reminders and does not change existing ones.

6. When a Reminder Fires

When the time arrives, the plane appears above other windows and keeps cruising.

- **Click the plane or the reminder text**: the flight lands immediately.
- **Snooze**: remind again in 10 or 30 minutes.
- **Skip today**: skip the remaining reminders for that item today.
- **Do nothing**: the plane lands automatically after the maximum flight time.
- **Click empty areas**: you can keep working in other windows; the overlay does not block the whole screen.
- **Cursor avoidance**: off by default; choose near, medium, or far. The aircraft and reminder card move together when the cursor is ahead, and both scale down in quarter or custom areas.

- **Landing notice**: clicking never turns the aircraft around. If the nose has already left the current flight area, the reminder ends immediately. If there is enough room, it lands using the normal approach distance; if not, the matching bottom corner (bottom-right when flying right, bottom-left when flying left) becomes the endpoint. Helicopter, drone, UFO, airship, and balloon types still land vertically in place. A short notice appears on the main page.
- **Several reminders at the same time**: flights take off one after another and do not overlap.
- **Flight preview**: use **Preview a flight** in Settings to see the effect in advance.

The overlay requires the app to be running. If you quit the app, reminders will not fire.

7. Managing Reminders

The route list on the main window lets you:

- Enable or pause a reminder
- Preview that reminder's flight
- Edit its text and settings
- Delete it
- Drag to reorder reminders

Paused reminders stay in the list but will not take off. The "Next" area at the top of the main window shows the nearest upcoming reminder.

8. Settings

When there are 5 or more enabled reminders, the flight plan header shows **Pause all**. After confirmation, all enabled reminders are switched off at once; no reminders are deleted.

Click **Settings** at the bottom right of the main window, or open Settings from the system tray menu.

Appearance & language

- **Appearance**: Light, Dark, or follow the system.
- **Language**: follow the system, or choose Simplified Chinese, Traditional Chinese, English, Japanese, Korean, Spanish, French, German, Italian, Dutch, or Swedish.
- **Theme style**: Skyline is free; Aurora, Sunset, Midnight, 1024, Candy, and Anime are Pro themes.
- **Reminder card style**: sets the default card style. The free version includes Skyline glass and Deep solid; Pro unlocks all six.
- **Flight paths**: manage custom routes. The free version keeps one; Pro is unlimited.
- **Interval window**: sets the default start and end time (09:00–18:00 initially) and lets you add multiple time templates. New interval reminders can follow the default, choose a template, or use custom times; each reminder can still override it.
- **Scene packs**: create office wellness, focus rhythm, medicine, or leave-work reminders in one click.
- **User guide**: open the online quick guide in the current app language.

Settings are saved automatically.

Runtime

- **Launch at login**: wait in the tray after you log in. On macOS, the app must be in **Applications**; this option is unavailable when running from the DMG.
- **Takeoff animation**: when enabled, the plane takes off and climbs into view; when disabled, it starts cruising directly.
- **Gentle mode**: smaller aircraft and fewer animations for focused work.
- **Flight area**: choose full screen, a screen quarter, or drag a custom area; each reminder can override it, and custom paths adapt to it.
- **Cursor avoidance**: off by default; choose near, medium, or far to make the aircraft and card avoid the pointer together.
- **Pause reminders**: temporarily pause everything; the main page shows the pause duration, countdown, and a resume button. Resuming asks for confirmation.
- **Meeting 30 / 60 min**: the selected duration stays highlighted. Click it again to cancel, or click the other duration to switch; nothing is selected by default.
- **Preview a flight**: show a sample flight immediately.
- **Max flight time**: default 5 minutes. Choose 5, 15, 30, or 60 minutes, or select **Custom** and enter 1–60 minutes.

How max flight time works:

Reminder type	Actual flight duration
Daily / Weekdays / Once	The configured maximum flight time
Interval	The smaller of the configured maximum and the reminder interval
Manual click	Lands immediately, regardless of the maximum
Flight preview	Follows the maximum flight time

Examples:

- Max flight time is 5 minutes: a normal reminder lands after 5 minutes.
- Interval is 10 minutes and max flight time is 60 minutes: the flight lasts at most 10 minutes so it does not overlap the next one.
- Interval is 1 hour and max flight time is 5 minutes: the flight lands after 5 minutes.

New reminder default

Sets the repeat mode preselected when creating a reminder. The default is **Weekdays**.

Default aircraft, height, and card

Sets the aircraft, flight height, and reminder card style used when creating a new reminder. Individual reminders can override these defaults.

Feedback

The About page shows active reminders, daily reminders, this week's completed count, and active days in the last seven days. You can also preview a weekly share card and choose where to save it, or export a full reminder backup (including default settings, flight paths, and custom aircraft images) and choose where to save it.

The **Feedback** item in the settings sidebar offers three options:

- Report a bug
- Suggest a feature
- General feedback

It opens your default email app with `runningswiftui@gmail.com`, including the app version and platform. The email subject and body follow the current app language.

9. System Tray

Closing the main window closes the interface, but the app process and tray icon remain.

Exit at the bottom of the settings sidebar hides the main window to the tray; **Settings** in the tray menu opens it again.

The tray menu typically contains:

- **Settings**: reopen the main window.
- **Preview flight**: show a flight preview immediately.
- **Quit**: exit the app completely; reminders will stop.

On macOS, the tray icon is in the menu bar. On Windows, it is usually in the notification area at the bottom right of the taskbar.

Only Quit in the tray menu ends the app. Closing the window, using Exit in the sidebar, or pressing Cmd+Q does not stop reminder scheduling.

10. Data, Backup, and Upgrades

Reminders and settings stay on your computer and are never uploaded to the internet.

Upgrading the app does not delete your data. The app does not currently include automatic updates; download and install a new version when needed, and your existing reminders will continue to work.

To keep a backup, copy the app data on your computer before upgrading or reinstalling. To remove all data, quit the app first, then delete the local app data. Uninstalling the app alone may not remove this data.

11. FAQ

No plane appeared at the scheduled time?

Check the following:

1. Is the app still running? Did you choose **Quit** from the tray menu?
2. Is the reminder paused?
3. For a **Once** reminder, has the date already passed?
4. For an **Interval** reminder, are you currently inside its start–end window?
5. Is the computer asleep or powered off? Reminders cannot appear while the computer is asleep.

Why didn't the reminder stay on screen forever?

A reminder cruises until you click it, but it lands automatically after the **Max flight time**. You can change that duration in Settings.

Why did an interval reminder land early?

For interval reminders, the actual flight duration is the smaller of the max flight time and the reminder interval. This prevents one flight from overlapping the next.

The installer says the app is unsigned or cannot be verified.

The current builds are not formally code-signed or notarized. On macOS, allow the app in **Privacy & Security**. On Windows, choose **More info → Run anyway** in the SmartScreen prompt. Only download installers from the project's Releases page.

My custom aircraft image does not appear.

Use PNG, JPG, or WebP. A transparent PNG usually looks best. Very large or unsupported files may fail to load; try another image.

Does the reminder make a sound?

The current experience is primarily visual: a plane and reminder text on screen. Keep the app running and watch your screen.

12. Suggested Uses

- Water, eye rest, and stretching: use **Interval** during your working hours, for example every 45 minutes.
- Medicine: use **Daily** or **Weekdays** at a fixed time.
- A one-off meeting or appointment: use **Once** and choose the date and time.
- Make reminders more noticeable: use a high flight height, a larger aircraft, a custom image, or the Neon night / Deep solid card style.
- Avoid choosing a repeat mode every time: set **New reminder default** in Settings.
- Have the app ready after login: put it in **Applications**, enable **Launch at login**, then close the window and let it run in the tray.